Materials & Textures

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Natural materials

White oak rift-sawn white oak with tight straight grain, pale natural finish

Walnut American black walnut with flowing grain and a warm oiled finish

Burl wood highly figured burl wood veneer with swirling grain and dark knot eyes, high-gloss finish

End grain end-grain butcher block of alternating maple and walnut squares, growth rings visible on each block

Plywood edge Baltic birch plywood with the layered striped edge exposed, clear matte finish

Reclaimed barn wood reclaimed weathered barn wood planks, silver-grey and brown, raised grain, nail holes and cracks

Bamboo natural bamboo poles in honey and green tones, with pronounced nodes

Cork agglomerated cork with coarse speckled granules in warm tan and brown

Rattan cane webbing woven rattan cane webbing in honey tones, open octagonal mesh

Carrara marble Carrara marble with soft feathery grey veining on a cool white ground

Calacatta marble Calacatta gold marble, bright white with bold dramatic grey and gold veining, polished

Nero Marquina Nero Marquina black marble with crisp white veining, polished to a mirror sheen

Travertine honed travertine in warm cream and beige, horizontal banding with small natural pits

Terrazzo terrazzo with large angular chips of terracotta, sage, black and white on a cream ground, polished

Granite polished salt-and-pepper granite with dense black, white and grey crystals

Slate riven blue-grey slate with a natural cleft surface and matte finish

Backlit onyx backlit honey onyx glowing amber, translucent wavy bands

Sandstone & rammed earth rammed earth wall with horizontal strata in ochre, rust and sand tones

Linen stonewashed natural linen in oatmeal, visible slubby weave and soft creases

Raw denim raw indigo selvedge denim with a visible diagonal twill and slight fading

Wool felt thick mustard merino wool felt with a soft fuzzy matte surface

Bouclé cream wool bouclé upholstery with a dense nubbly looped texture

Velvet deep emerald cotton velvet with a soft pile sheen catching light at the folds

Full-grain leather vegetable-tanned cognac full-grain leather with visible pores, faint creases and cream saddle stitching

Suede sand-colored suede with a soft brushed nap and gentle tonal shifts

Cotton canvas heavyweight natural cotton duck canvas with a coarse even weave

Chunky knit chunky cream wool cable knit with plump V stitches and soft fuzz

Herringbone tweed grey-brown herringbone wool tweed with colorful flecks

Built & industrial

Board-formed concrete board-formed raw concrete wall with visible timber grain imprints, plank seams and small air pockets

Polished concrete polished concrete floor, mottled grey with exposed fine aggregate and soft blurred reflections

Tadelakt burnished tadelakt lime plaster in warm clay pink, seamless, soft cloudy tones and a waxy sheen

Limewash limewashed wall in warm stone white, chalky matte, soft mottled crisscross brush strokes

Stucco rough white knockdown stucco wall, raking sunlight picking out the texture

Terracotta tile unglazed terracotta floor tiles in mixed rust and orange tones, matte, with pale grout

Zellige handmade green zellige tiles with uneven glossy glaze, tile-to-tile color variation and wavy edges

Crackle glaze pale celadon crackle glaze with a fine web of dark crazing lines, glossy

Brick exposed reclaimed red brick wall in running bond, mixed tones, recessed lime mortar

Brushed steel brushed stainless steel with fine linear grain and soft streaked highlights

Polished chrome mirror-polished chrome with crisp, high-contrast reflections of sky and horizon

Brass polished brass with warm golden reflections

Copper polished copper with rosy orange reflections and slight warm tarnish

Blackened steel waxed blackened hot-rolled steel, dark charcoal with blue-grey mill scale mottling and a low sheen

Corten steel Corten weathering steel panels with a deep, even orange-brown rust patina

Hammered metal hand-hammered copper with overlapping dimpled facets catching small highlights

Anodized aluminum satin anodized aluminum in cobalt blue with a fine metallic sheen

Galvanized steel hot-dip galvanized steel with a crystalline zinc spangle pattern

Clear glass clear optical glass with sharp refraction, dark edges and crisp specular highlights

Frosted glass frosted acid-etched glass panel, objects behind it softened into blurred glowing shapes

Reeded glass reeded fluted glass with vertical ribs fragmenting the colors behind it into slivers

Dichroic glass dichroic glass panels shifting from cyan to magenta to gold, casting colored light

Colored acrylic transparent colored acrylic sheets overlapping, glowing cut edges and colored shadows

Glossy plastic glossy injection-molded ABS plastic in tomato red, smooth with a crisp highlight

Recycled plastic recycled plastic sheet with colorful speckled and swirled flecks, satin finish

Rubber matte black studded rubber flooring with raised round dots

Carbon fiber glossy 2x2 twill carbon fiber weave under a deep clear coat

Finishes & wear

Matte dead-flat matte finish with no reflections, soft even shading

Eggshell eggshell finish with a faint soft sheen

Satin satin finish with a soft, blurred highlight

High gloss high-gloss finish with crisp highlights and clear reflections

Piano lacquer piano-black mirror lacquer with deep, razor-sharp reflections

Soft-touch soft-touch rubberized matte coating with a velvety, powdery sheen

Pearlescent pearlescent white finish with soft pink and green iridescent shifts

Metallic flake candy-apple red metallic flake paint under a glossy clear coat, fine sparkles

Sandblasted bead-blasted aluminium with a fine, even satin-grey frost

Powder coat satin powder-coated steel in signal orange with a faint orange-peel texture

Vitreous enamel vitreous enamel sign in cobalt blue and white, glossy with small black chips at the edges

Shou sugi ban shou sugi ban charred cedar with a black alligator-scale crust and silvery sheen

Oiled wood oiled walnut with a hand-rubbed hardwax oil finish, rich grain and a soft low sheen

Gold leaf hand-laid 23-carat gold leaf with visible square seams and small breaks showing red bole

Flocked deep red velvet flock damask pattern on a cream wallpaper ground

Knurled precision diamond-knurled stainless steel grip next to polished bands

Patina unlacquered brass with a warm, uneven patina, rubbed bright where hands touch it

Verdigris weathered copper covered in chalky blue-green verdigris, with streaks running down

Rust heavily rusted steel with orange and brown blooms, pitting and flaking scale

Peeling paint flaking pale blue paint peeling off weathered grey wood, crisp curled edges

Sun-faded sun-faded red and cream stripes, bleached pale, with a vivid unfaded rectangle where a frame once hung

Crackle antique craquelure, a fine web of dark hairline cracks across aged cream glaze

Edge wear olive-green painted steel with worn edges and corners chipped back to bright bare metal

Kintsugi kintsugi repaired stoneware bowl, dark glaze crossed by branching seams of bright gold

Print processes

Risograph two-color risograph print in fluorescent pink and blue on cream paper, grainy ink coverage, overlapping colors and slight misregistration

Letterpress letterpress printed in navy ink on thick white cotton paper, deep debossed impression you can see in the raking light

Screen print three-color screen print poster, flat opaque inks in mustard, brick red and navy, crisp edges with slight overlaps

Offset lithography offset-printed four-color CMYK image, visible halftone rosettes up close

Newsprint halftone coarse black newsprint halftone photo with large visible dots on grey newsprint paper

Photocopy photocopied zine page, harsh high-contrast black and white, toner speckle and copier streaks, collaged and taped

Duotone duotone image in deep navy and warm orange, shadows in navy and highlights in orange

Linocut black linocut print on cream paper, bold carved shapes and tapered white gouge marks, slightly uneven ink

Woodcut woodcut print in black with a flat red second block, angular carved lines, wood grain showing in the solid ink

Etching fine-line etching in warm black ink, cross-hatched shading, soft plate tone and a visible plate mark on heavy cream paper

Engraving banknote-style line engraving in dark green, fine parallel shading lines and intricate guilloche rosettes

Stone lithograph stone lithograph with grainy crayon shading and flat areas of mustard and red, on warm aged paper

Cyanotype cyanotype sun print, deep Prussian blue with white fern and leaf silhouettes, brushed edges on watercolor paper

Stencil spray spray paint stencil on a concrete wall, soft overspray edges, stencil bridges in the letters and a few drips

Hand block print hand block-printed cotton with a small repeating floral motif in madder red and black, slightly uneven ink and registration

Foil stamping gold hot-foil stamped lettering and border on deep navy uncoated card, metallic sheen catching the light

Blind embossing blind embossed crest raised from thick white cotton card, no ink, revealed by soft raking light

Debossing debossed lettering pressed into thick kraft board, no ink, crisp sunken edges

Spot UV matte black card with a glossy spot UV pattern and logo, visible only where the light reflects

Die cut die-cut cover with a round window and arch cut-outs revealing a patterned inner page, crisp cut edges with soft shadow

Thermography thermographed business card with glossy raised black ink lettering on bright white stock

Edge painting stack of thick cotton business cards with hot pink painted edges

Paper & imperfections

Newsprint printed on grey-cream newsprint with soft absorbent ink and faint show-through

Kraft paper printed in black ink on unbleached brown kraft paper with visible fibers

Cotton rag paper thick cold-press cotton rag paper with a pronounced soft tooth, warm white

Deckle edge handmade paper with soft feathered deckle edges

Washi translucent kozo washi paper with long visible mulberry fibers, softly backlit

Vellum a translucent frosted vellum overlay softly veiling the print beneath

Gloss coated paper printed on glossy coated magazine paper, saturated color and a soft glare across the page

Corrugated cardboard corrugated cardboard with a torn top layer revealing the wavy brown flutes

Marbled paper hand-marbled endpaper with combed swirls of indigo, rust and gold on cream

Misregistration slight misregistration between the ink layers, colors shifted a few millimeters off their outlines

Ink bleed soft ink bleed into absorbent paper, edges slightly feathered and swollen

Moiré a visible moiré interference pattern from two overlapping fine line screens

Uneven ink coverage uneven, mottled ink coverage in the solid areas, with speckles of paper showing through

Fold lines & creases creased from being folded in quarters, the ink cracked and worn white along the fold lines

Foxing & age stains aged paper with brown foxing spots, yellowed edges and a faint coffee ring stain

Overprint transparent overprinting inks, fluorescent pink, yellow and blue mixing into new colors where they overlap

Torn paper collage layered torn paper collage, rough white fibrous tear edges and strips of masking tape

3D & digital surfaces

Roughness low roughness, crisp sharp reflections

Metalness fully metallic gold surface with tinted, mirror-like reflections

Subsurface scattering subsurface scattering, soft waxy translucency with warm light glowing through the edges

Anisotropic spun brushed aluminium with anisotropic reflections forming a bow-tie highlight

Clearcoat deep red car paint with a glossy clearcoat, sharp top reflections over a soft colored glow

Thin-film iridescence thin-film iridescence like a soap bubble, swirling magenta, green and gold bands

Transmission & refraction solid clear glass sphere refracting the background upside down, IOR 1.5, bright caustic on the floor

Displacement true displacement mapping, deep bumpy surface relief that breaks the silhouette

Claymation claymation style, soft plasticine with visible fingerprints and slightly lumpy hand-sculpted forms

Felt craft felt craft style, fuzzy wool felt cut-outs with visible blanket stitching

Layered paper cut layered paper-cut diorama, stacked colored paper with crisp edges and soft shadows between layers

Glassmorphism glassmorphism, a frosted translucent glass card with a thin white border over vivid blurred color blobs

Liquid chrome liquid chrome blob, molten mirror-polished metal with flowing sharp reflections

Holographic foil holographic iridescent foil with pastel rainbow gradients and a crinkled metallic sheen

Inflatable inflatable puffy 3D shapes, glossy balloon-like vinyl with soft rounded seams

Vinyl toy designer vinyl toy figure, glossy smooth molded plastic, big head and simple face